

Comprehensive English notes from the morning current affairs class (Session date: August 24, 2026), including the one-liner revision content attached to each news item as taught. All facts, figures, names, MCQs and quick-revision points from the session are included below.

1. Two Ships Hijacked Near Yemen & Somalia — 22 Indians Aboard

- **MT Shibu One** — flying the flag of **Eritrea**, hijacked off the coast of **Yemen**, in the **Gulf of Aden**; **6 Indian** crew members aboard.
- A second vessel flying the flag of **Cameroon**, hijacked near **Somalia**, close to the island region of **Puntland** (part of Somalia, with no shared land border); **16 Indian** crew members aboard.
- Total Indians affected across both hijackings: **22**.

Regional geography recap:

- Yemen's capital: **Sana'a**; key port city: **Aden**.
- Countries bordering the **Gulf of Aden**: **Yemen, Somalia, Djibouti**.
- The **Bab-el-Mandeb Strait** is a key gateway/alternative route near this region.
- **Horn of Africa** comprises 4 countries — remembered as "**SEED**": **Somalia, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Djibouti**.

Gulf-based Quick MCQs (Recap)

- World's largest Gulf: **Gulf of Mexico** (recently renamed **Gulf of America**).
- Gulf between India and Sri Lanka: **Gulf of Mannar / Palk Strait**.
- New book on **Sonia Gandhi**: "**Belonging: A Journey of Love**".
- Gulf between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula: **Persian Gulf**.
- Gulf connecting to the Mediterranean Sea: **Gulf of Sidra**.
- Gulf between the USA and Mexico: **Gulf of Mexico**.
- Gulf/strait on the Red Sea: **Bab-el-Mandeb**.
- Waterway between Saudi Arabia and the Sinai Peninsula: **Suez Canal**.

2. Qeshm Island (Iran) — Mangrove Forests Damaged by Oil Spill

- **Qeshm Island** (Iran) has green/grey **mangrove forests** that are deteriorating due to an **oil spill** reaching the area.
- Located in the **Persian Gulf**, near the **Strait of Hormuz**, which connects to the **Gulf of Oman**; the strait is controlled by **Iran**.
- Nearby strait: **Khuran Strait**.
- Region is **UNESCO-conserved** (Biosphere Reserve status); species found here are classified **Critically Endangered** by IUCN — e.g., the **Hawksbill Turtle**.

India's Mangroves (Recap)

- India's largest mangrove forest: the **Sundarbans** (delta region, West Bengal); known for **Sundari trees** and the **Royal Bengal Tiger** (West Bengal's state animal).
- Mangrove conservation scheme: **MISHTI Yojana**.

3. Vegetation Types – Quick Recap

Condition / Region	Vegetation Type
Areas of heavy rainfall	Evergreen Forest
Deciduous forest belt in India	Central India
Monsoon forest (alternate name)	Tropical Deciduous Forest
Dry areas	Thorn Forest
Thorn forest mainly found in (India)	Rajasthan
Himalayan region vegetation	Alpine

4. Durand Cup 2026 (Football) — Concluded

- **Asia's oldest football tournament**; started in **1888**, from **Shimla, Himachal Pradesh**; named after **Sir Mortimer Durand**.
- Sponsor: **Indian Oil**; hosted in **West Bengal**.
- Clubs with the most titles: **Mohun Bagan** and **East Bengal** — **17 titles each** (after this edition).
- This year's edition: **135th edition**; final: **Mohun Bagan vs East Bengal**.
- Winner: **East Bengal** (their **17th title**), winning **4–1**.
- Venue/Stadium: **Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan** (Salt Lake Stadium), West Bengal.

5. Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme

- Announced in the **2026 Union Budget**, under the **Ministry of Electronics and IT**.
- Two targets: (1) increase overall **mobile phone manufacturing in India**, and (2) boost manufacturing by **domestic Indian companies** (e.g., Micromax, boAt).
- Total investment allocated: **■62,500 crore** (equally split between the two targets).
- Implementation period: **2026 to 2030–31**.
- Target: raise the domestic manufacturers' share from the current **~23%** to **40–50%**; performance-linked incentives will be given to manufacturers.
- Announced by Union Minister **Ashwini Vaishnaw**.

PM Surya Ghar & PM Internship Scheme (Recap)

- **PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana** is implemented by the **Ministry of Renewable/New & Renewable Energy**; provides up to **300 units** free electricity per month; launched from **Ayodhya**.
- **PM Internship Scheme**: target of **1 crore youth** to be given internships over **5 years**; monthly assistance of **₹5,000** per intern.

6. INS Mangrol — 3rd Anti-Submarine Shallow Water Craft

- Third **Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft (ASW-SWC)** handed over to the **Indian Navy**; named **INS Mangrol**.
- Named after a former minor port in **Junagadh district, Gujarat**; an earlier ship of the same name was decommissioned in **2004**.
- Role: **underwater surveillance and search**; fitted with **radar** and **sonar** systems.
- Built by **Cochin Shipyard Limited**; launched at **Kochi, Kerala**, on **21 August 2026**; about **80% indigenous** content.
- First two ships in this series: **INS Arnala** (1st) and **INS Androth** (2nd).

Other Recent Navy Milestones (Recap)

- **Launch and Recovery System** — recently tested by the Indian Navy at **Visakhapatnam** (for tracking/recovering unmanned platforms at sea).
- India's first **indigenously designed naval platform**: **INS Nilgiri (Project 17A)** — includes Nilgiri, Udaygiri, Dunagiri, Mahendragiri, etc.).
- **Project 15B** (Guided Missile Destroyers): **Visakhapatnam, Mormugao, Imphal, Surat**.
- **Project 75** (Submarines): includes **INS Vagsheer**.
- **INS Arnala**: commissioned as a shallow water craft in **June 2025**.
- **INS Nistar**: a **Diving Support Vessel**, launched in **July 2025**.

7. Sophie Adenot — First French Woman to Complete a Spacewalk

- **Sophie Adenot** (France) becomes the **first French woman** and **2nd European woman** to perform a spacewalk.
- Her mission launched on **13 February 2026**, aboard the **SpaceX Dragon spacecraft**, as part of **Crew-12**.
- Reached the **International Space Station (ISS)** on **14 February 2026**; conducted the spacewalk alongside NASA astronaut **Anil Menon** (of Indian origin).
- Duration of this spacewalk: **6 hours 23 minutes**.

Spacewalk Records (Recap Quiz)

Record	Astronaut / Detail
First woman to complete a spacewalk	Claudie (1996)
First European woman spacewalker	Samantha (Cristoforetti) – Italy
Longest cumulative spacewalk duration (woman)	Sunita Williams – 62 hours 6 minutes
First French / 2nd European woman spacewalker (2026)	Sophie Adenot

8. ISRO Missions – Quick Recap

- **NISAR** satellite launched using **GSLV-F16**.
- **SpaDeX Mission** (India's docking-capability demo mission): the last major mission of the previous year, launched in **December 2025** using two satellites.
- **NVS-2** navigation satellite launched via **GSLV-F15**, in **January 2025**, for navigation purposes.
- A newly discovered exoplanet, about **170 million years old** and **23 times more massive** than typical planets, has been termed a **"Mega-Earth"**.

9. National Space Day — 23 August

- Marks the **Chandrayaan-3** mission's Moon landing; mission launched by **ISRO** on **14 July 2023**, and landed on **23 August 2023**.
- Landed on the **Moon's South Pole** — India became the **first country** to land there, and the 4th country to soft-land on the Moon.
- Lander name: **Vikram**; launch rocket: **LVM3**, nicknamed the **"Bahubali rocket"**.
- The landing site is named the **Shiv Shakti Point**.
- This year (2026) marks the **3rd edition** of National Space Day celebrations.

Chandrayaan Series (Recap)

- **Chandrayaan-1** (2008): searched for water on the Moon; launched via **PSLV-C11**.
- **Chandrayaan-2** (July 2019): attempted South Pole landing but did not succeed; its landing site is called the **Tiranga Point**; launched via **GSLV Mk III**.
- **Chandrayaan-3** (2023): successful landing, launched via **LVM3 (Mk III/IV)**.
- Upcoming **LUPEX Mission** (India–Japan joint Moon mission) will be **Chandrayaan-5**.

10. Madras Day — 22 August

- In **1640**, the **British East India Company** (with **Francis Day**) built **Fort St. George** in the region.
- The land was gifted to the East India Company by **Damarla Venkatapathy Nayak**.
- **Madras** was founded in **1639**; renamed **Chennai** on **14 January 1969**; now part of **Tamil Nadu**.
- This year marks **387 years** since its founding; Madras Day was first celebrated in **2004**.
- Tamil Nadu's **Statehood Day** is celebrated on **1 November 1956**.
- Though the city is now Chennai, the High Court is still called the **Madras High Court**. Its jurisdiction covers **Puducherry** cases; **Andaman & Nicobar** cases go to the **Calcutta High Court**; **Lakshadweep** cases go to the **Kerala High Court**.

11. Commonwealth Cue Sports Championship 2026

- To be held in **October 2026** in **Ahmedabad**, which is being developed as India's **Sports Capital** (also set to host the **2030 Commonwealth Games**).
- Venue: **Veer Savarkar Sports Complex**; this will be the **2nd edition**.
- Sports included: **Billiards** and **Snooker** — billiards uses **3 balls**, snooker uses **22 balls**.
- About **45 countries** to participate, across **5 categories**, competing for a total of **10 medals**.
- Organised by the **World Confederation of Billiards Sports**.

12. BWF World Championship — Bronze for India (Badminton)

- Indian women's doubles pair **Treesa Jolly** and **Gayatri Gopichand** won the **Bronze medal** at the BWF World Championship, after losing in the semifinals (having earlier beaten China).
- Event held at the **Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, Delhi**.
- This is only the **2nd time** India has won a medal at this event — the first was in **2011**, also a Bronze, won by **Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa**.
- **BWF (Badminton World Federation)** headquarters: **Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia**.

13. All MCQs Asked in the Session

Q1. How many Indians in total were affected by the recent hijacking of two vessels near Yemen and Somalia?

Ans: 22 (6 on MT Shibu One + 16 on the Cameroon-flagged vessel)

Q2. MT Shibu One, hijacked off Yemen's coast, was flying which country's flag?

Ans: Eritrea

Q3. Near which Somali region/island was the second (Cameroon-flagged) vessel hijacked?

Ans: Puntland

Q4. Which four countries make up the 'Horn of Africa'?

Ans: Somalia, Eritrea, Ethiopia, Djibouti (remembered as 'SEED')

Q5. Which is the world's largest Gulf, and what has it been renamed?

Ans: Gulf of Mexico, renamed Gulf of America

Q6. Which Gulf/Strait lies between India and Sri Lanka?

Ans: Gulf of Mannar / Palk Strait

Q7. What is the title of the newly launched book on Sonia Gandhi?

Ans: Belonging: A Journey of Love

Q8. Which Gulf lies between Iran and the Arabian Peninsula?

Ans: Persian Gulf

Q9. Which Gulf connects to the Mediterranean Sea?

Ans: Gulf of Sidra

Q10. Which Gulf lies between the USA and Mexico?

Ans: Gulf of Mexico

Q11. Which strait/gulf is located on the Red Sea?

Ans: Bab-el-Mandeb

Q12. What connects Saudi Arabia and the Sinai Peninsula?

Ans: Suez Canal

Q13. Qeshm Island, known for mangrove forests damaged by an oil spill, belongs to which country?

Ans: Iran

Q14. Qeshm Island is located in which Gulf, near which strait?

Ans: Persian Gulf, near the Strait of Hormuz

Q15. Which endangered turtle species is found around Qeshm Island?

Ans: Hawksbill Turtle (IUCN status: Critically Endangered)

Q16. What is the name of India's mangrove conservation scheme?

Ans: MISHTI Yojana

Q17. What type of vegetation is found in areas of heavy rainfall?

Ans: Evergreen Forest

Q18. Monsoon forest is also known by which name?

Ans: Tropical Deciduous Forest

Q19. Thorn forests are mainly found in which Indian state?

Ans: Rajasthan

Q20. What type of vegetation is found in the Himalayan region?

Ans: Alpine vegetation

Q21. In which year did the Durand Cup begin, and from where?

Ans: 1888, from Shimla, Himachal Pradesh

Q22. Which two clubs have won the most Durand Cup titles, and how many each?

Ans: Mohun Bagan and East Bengal — 17 titles each (after 2026)

Q23. Who won the 135th Durand Cup final, and by what score?

Ans: East Bengal beat Mohun Bagan 4–1

Q24. What is the name of the stadium where the Durand Cup final was hosted?

Ans: Vivekananda Yuba Bharati Krirangan, West Bengal

Q25. What is the total investment allocated under the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme?

Ans: ₹62,500 crore

Q26. Which ministry launched the Mobile Phone Manufacturing Scheme?

Ans: Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology

Q27. What is the target share of domestic manufacturers under this scheme?

Ans: Increase from ~23% to 40–50%

Q28. Which ministry implements the PM Surya Ghar Muft Bijli Yojana?

Ans: Ministry of (New & Renewable Energy)

Q29. What is the maximum free electricity provided per month under PM Surya Ghar?

Ans: 300 units

Q30. What is the target of the PM Internship Scheme?

Ans: 1 crore youth to be given internships over 5 years

Q31. What is the monthly financial assistance given under the PM Internship Scheme?

Ans: ₹5,000 per month

Q32. What is the name of India's 3rd Anti-Submarine Warfare Shallow Water Craft, recently handed to the Navy?

Ans: INS Mangrol

Q33. Which shipyard built INS Mangrol, and where was it launched?

Ans: Cochin Shipyard Limited; launched at Kochi, Kerala, on 21 August 2026

Q34. What percentage of INS Mangrol is indigenously built?

Ans: About 80%

Q35. What are the names of the first two ships in this shallow water craft series?

Ans: INS Arnala (1st) and INS Androth (2nd)

Q36. Where did the Indian Navy recently test the 'Launch and Recovery System'?

Ans: Visakhapatnam

Q37. What is India's first indigenously designed naval platform, and under which project?

Ans: INS Nilgiri, under Project 17A

Q38. Name the ships under Project 15B (Guided Missile Destroyers).

Ans: Visakhapatnam, Mormugao, Imphal, Surat

Q39. Which submarine is associated with Project 75?

Ans: INS Vagsheer

Q40. When was INS Nistar (Diving Support Vessel) launched?

Ans: July 2025

Q41. Who became the first French woman (and 2nd European woman) to complete a spacewalk?

Ans: Sophie Adenot

Q42. When was Sophie Adenot's mission launched, and via which spacecraft?

Ans: 13 February 2026, aboard SpaceX Dragon (Crew-12)

Q43. Which Indian-origin NASA astronaut joined Sophie Adenot for the spacewalk?

Ans: Anil Menon

Q44. What was the duration of Sophie Adenot's spacewalk?

Ans: 6 hours 23 minutes

Q45. Who was the first woman to complete a spacewalk, and in which year?

Ans: Claudie, in 1996

Q46. Who was the first European woman to complete a spacewalk?

Ans: Samantha (Cristoforetti), from Italy

Q47. Who holds the record for the longest cumulative spacewalk duration among women?

Ans: Sunita Williams — 62 hours 6 minutes

Q48. Which launch vehicle was used for the NISAR satellite?

Ans: GSLV-F16

Q49. What is India's docking-capability demonstration mission called, and when was it launched?

Ans: SpaDeX Mission, launched December 2025

Q50. Which launch vehicle carried the NVS-2 navigation satellite, and when?

Ans: GSLV-F15, in January 2025

Q51. A newly discovered exoplanet, 170 million years old, has been given what name?

Ans: 'Mega-Earth'

Q52. On which date is National Space Day observed, and why?

Ans: 23 August — marks Chandrayaan-3's Moon landing (2023)

Q53. When was Chandrayaan-3 launched, and by whom?

Ans: 14 July 2023, by ISRO

Q54. Where did Chandrayaan-3 land, and what significance did this hold for India?

Ans: Moon's South Pole — India became the first country to land there

Q55. What is the name of the Chandrayaan-3 lander and the landing point?

Ans: Lander — Vikram; Landing point — Shiv Shakti Point

Q56. Which rocket launched Chandrayaan-3, and by what nickname is it known?

Ans: LVM3, nicknamed the 'Bahubali rocket'

Q57. What was Chandrayaan-2's landing site called, despite its unsuccessful landing?

Ans: Tiranga Point

Q58. What will India's upcoming Moon mission with Japan (LUPEX) be officially called?

Ans: Chandrayaan-5

Q59. On which date is Madras Day celebrated, and how many years did the city complete in 2026?

Ans: 22 August; 387 years

Q60. Who built Fort St. George in Madras, and in which year?

Ans: The British East India Company (with Francis Day), in 1640

Q61. Who gifted the land (that became Madras) to the East India Company?

Ans: Damarla Venkatapathy Nayak

Q62. When was Madras renamed Chennai?

Ans: 14 January 1969

Q63. When is Tamil Nadu's Statehood Day celebrated?

Ans: 1 November 1956

Q64. Cases from which Union Territories go to the Calcutta High Court and the Kerala High Court respectively?

Ans: Andaman & Nicobar – Calcutta High Court; Lakshadweep – Kerala High Court

Q65. Where will the Commonwealth Cue Sports Championship 2026 be held?

Ans: Ahmedabad (Veer Savarkar Sports Complex), in October 2026

Q66. How many balls are used in billiards versus snooker?

Ans: Billiards – 3 balls; Snooker – 22 balls

Q67. How many countries and medal categories are expected at the Commonwealth Cue Sports Championship 2026?

Ans: 45 countries; 10 medals across 5 categories

Q68. Which Indian pair won the Bronze medal at the BWF World Championship 2026?

Ans: Treesa Jolly and Gayatri Gopichand (Women's Doubles)

Q69. Where was the BWF World Championship 2026 held?

Ans: Indira Gandhi Indoor Stadium, Delhi

Q70. Who won India's first medal (Bronze) at this championship, and in which year?

Ans: Jwala Gutta and Ashwini Ponnappa, in 2011

Q71. Where is the headquarters of the Badminton World Federation (BWF)?

Ans: Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

Note: This session had no separate 'extra revision' segment — one-line revision content was woven into each news item, as reflected above. A new GK series (covering Temples, for Steno/Phase/CGL/CHSL/MTS/Lower PCS/Defence exams) also began from this date's 11:00 AM class.